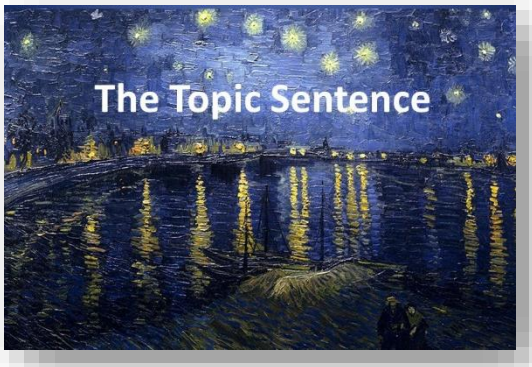
‘We know what we are but know not what we may be.’
William Shakespeare

ACADEMIC WRITING: Topic Sentences and Paragraph Structure

Developed and compiled by
Michael Warrick

DISCUSSION



1. **Discuss following questions:**

   a) What is the function of a topic sentence?

   b) Where is the topic sentence usually situated?

   c) The paragraph should show unity. What is unity?

   d) How many sentences would a typical paragraph for a short essay (about 350 words) contain?

   e) Must there be a concluding sentence for each paragraph?

TOPIC SENTENCES

The topic sentence is the most important part of a paragraph. It should be general enough to express the paragraph's main topic and specific enough to show principal features of that topic. The topic sentence has two components:

- **The topic**
  This gives the topic paragraph and often *contains a noun / noun phrase*

- **The controlling idea**
  This limits the topic to specific points or details, and usually *contains a verb*

1. **Match the topics with their controlling ideas:**

   a) Having both mental and physical strength

   b) An important role of library staff

   c) Management styles

   d) People with strong musical intelligence

   e) The language barrier

i) is to offer undergraduates both suitable resources and training.

ii) have an ability to produce and appreciate music.

iii) often hinders effective communication in multinational companies.

iv) can vary significantly between different cultures.

v) is essential for Olympic athletes.

The controlling idea is too general (*when, where, to what extent?*).

Poor topic sentences

- *The pace of decline in UK unemployment has accelerated.*

- *The UK unemployment rate is now exceptionally low and stands at 4% (Ferreira, 2018).*

Too specific, giving supporting detail that should be in paragraph.

ANALYSIS OF TOPIC SENTENCES

1. Note whether the topic sentences below are too general, too specific or adequate. You should also suggest improvements where appropriate:

TOO SPECIFIC/ TOO GENERAL / ADEQUATE	TOPIC SENTENCE
	a) It is estimated that the red squirrel population is now just 15,000.
	b) Seminars are a very important aspect.
	c) Part-time jobs can benefit students in a number of ways.
	d) London in the 1880's was crowded and booming economically.
	e) Mediterranean countries share similar climatic features.

	f) It can be argued that global economic growth has been beneficial.
	g) Smart phones perform a variety of useful functions, such as instant messaging, mobile payments, navigation and sending/receiving emails, etc.
	h) Larger Chinese cities offer migrants more amenities and a better quality of life.

CHOOSE THE BEST TOPIC SENTENCE

Read each paragraph (group work). Choose the best topic sentence from the four options.

For each item:

1. Choose the best topic sentence (a, b, c, or d).
2. Justify your choice in 2–3 sentences.

1. Read each paragraph. **Choose the best topic sentence from the 4 options given:**

a) The different types of mountain climbing require special skills.

b) There are three main categories of mountain climbing, with varying levels of difficulty.

c) Mountain climbing is a difficult sport.

d) People around the world practice mountain climbing.

Trail climbing is the easiest, where climbers walk along trails to the top of a mountain. The trails are not usually steep, and the mountains are relatively low. The second type, rock climbing, takes place on steeper slopes and higher mountains. Knowledge of proper climbing techniques and the use of specialized climbing equipment, such as climbing shoes and ropes, are crucial for the safe completion of routes. The third type is ice climbing, which takes place on very high mountains. This sport is considered hazardous because ice climbers may be exposed to inclement weather conditions, avalanches and crevasses. For those who choose this sport, however, such risks only add to the thrill of climbing on ice.

Correct answer: …….

Why it fits:

Why others are less appropriate:

- …
- …
- …

2.

a) Fell running, which takes place on challenging terrain, differs from trail running and cross-country running.

b) Fell running differs from other types of running by taking place on all kinds of terrain.

c) Fell running, trail running and cross-country running are very different.

d) Fell running is a sport that offers challenges regarding the terrain gradient and ruggedness.

In the United Kingdom and Ireland it is also called mountain running, although the two types are not identical. Fell running involves running between two checkpoints often without a clear path, and the runner may even have the freedom to choose the route. It differs from trail running in that it generally takes place on mountainous terrain which is remote, rugged and unpredictable, and where the ascents and descents tend to be steeper. Trail running takes place on clearly marked hiking trails, along terrains that are less changeable. It is difficult to definitively distinguish fell running from cross country running. In general, however, cross country is typically raced over shorter distances (rarely over 12 kilometers) and has less climbing and clearer routes.

Correct answer: …….

Why it fits:

Why others are less appropriate:

- …
- …
- …

3.

a) Human activity is destroying habitats and threatening certain UK mammal populations with extinction.

b) Farming is threatening the extinction of mammal populations in the UK.

c) Agricultural practices and urbanization are gradually destroying important UK habitats.

d) The eradication of UK habitats due to urbanization is endangering the hedgehog, greater mouse-eared bat, black rat and wildcat.

Road and building construction has entailed the loss of hedgerows, permanent grasslands and areas of forest, the natural home of many UK mammals. It also creates barriers between habitats, thus isolating some populations and in turn reducing their genetic fitness. Intensive farming methods have further fragmented and reduced habitats, while the use of pesticides has exterminated their insect food sources. As a consequence, species of mammal have become endangered; those at greatest risk of annihilation include the wildcat, the black rat and the greater mouse-eared bat (Carson, 2019). Another threatened mammal is the hedgehog, whose population has plunged by two thirds since 1995, due mainly to vehicle collisions, deaths, loss of hedgerows and reduced availability of insect larvae (Johnson, 2018).

Correct answer: …….
Why it fits:

Why others are less appropriate:

- …
- …
- …

4.

a) Melatonin may be inhibited by light from blue screens, leading to poor sleep outcomes and breast cancer.
b) Any fall in the production of melatonin may result in cancer, especially breast cancer.
c) Lower levels of melatonin at night due to blue light may be detrimental.
d) Reduced melatonin secretion at night may impair both sleep and physical health.

It is well established that production of this hormone is significantly suppressed by the electric light bulb at night and, more damagingly, by the blue light emitted by screens on smart phones, televisions and computers. The consequent reduction in melatonin is associated with poor sleep outcomes, such as sleep disruption and diminished sleep duration. It has further been linked to higher rates of certain cancers, such as breast cancer in women and prostate cancer in men (Lambert and Jones, 2016) and has been found to absorb free radicals, which are estimated to cause almost 70% of damage to DNA and biological membranes (Thompson, 2019).

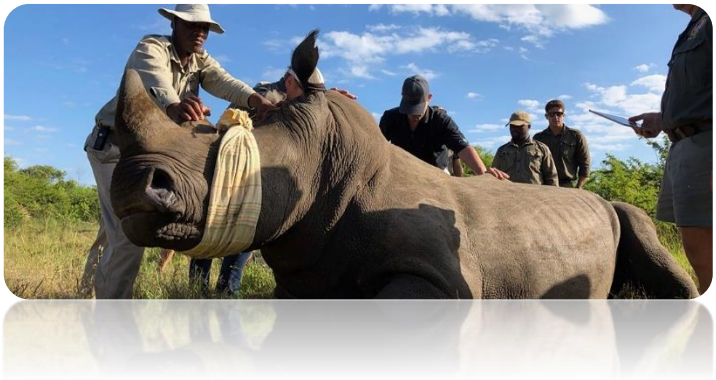
Correct answer: …….

Why it fits:

Why others are less appropriate:

- …
- …
- …

5.



a) Security and monitoring are vital to ensure the effectiveness of dehorning in African reserves.

b) Dehorning, which is the removal of the rhino's horns, is the most effective means of saving the rhino in Africa.

c) Dehorning is one of several measures that may be utilized to discourage poachers in African countries.

d) The dehorning of rhinos, as a solution to poaching, has met with limited success in Africa.

It is often claimed that this can deter poachers since it renders the practice unprofitable, thereby reducing the incentive to kill rhinos (Harvey, 2018; Jones *et al*., 2019). There have been some success stories across Africa. Rhinos dehorned in small reserves in Zimbabwe, for example, generally have a 29.1% higher chance of surviving than horned animals (Carlsen and Cole, 2020). On the other hand, poaching has continued to increase in several other countries and reserves, despite dehorning. This could be due to a variety of reasons - for instance, it has been shown that in areas with limited anti-poaching security, poachers have simply waited for the horns to grow back or have even killed rhino's for their stubs - as these are still considered valuable (Watson, 2021). Dehorning may therefore only be effective in particular reserves, and when accompanied by additional other anti-poaching strategies, such as security and monitoring efforts.

Correct answer: …….

Why it fits:

Why others are less appropriate:

- …
- …
- …

USEFUL NOUNS AND ADJECTIVES FOR TOPIC SENTENCES

1. **Allocate the following words to the table below so that each box contains words with a similar meaning:**

a number of, technique, attribute, category, characteristic, class, domain, detrimental, field, adverse, procedure, objective, variety, positive, property, numerous, approach, useful, various, favourable, quality, negative, function, sector, several, factor, means, countless, deleterious

MANY (determiner/pronoun) *a variety of*	**PURPOSE (noun)** *aim, role*
TYPE *kind*	**BENEFICIAL** *advantageous*
ASPECT *feature*	**HARMFUL** *hazardous*
METHOD *way*	**AREA** *discipline*

2. Complete the sentences below with a term from the table above. Each word may only be used once

field	positive	number	category	discipline
approach	procedure	deleterious	function	feature

a) Urban renewal will eliminate the slums, where conditions have become …….. to health.

b) Proteins serve many vital …….. in living organisms.

c) After World War II, a high level of military spending became a permanent ……. of the US economy.

d) The three main types, or …….., of rock are sedimentary, metamorphic, and igneous.

e) The Secretary General ensures that all committees act in accordance with formal ……..…….

f) The study of most leisure activities falls within the …… of psychology, physical education and sociology.

g) Leadership has been an important …… of research among social scientists for decades.

h) Psychologists have taken many different ……. to studying perception.

i) A large …… of people were employed in menial jobs.

j) Koller was optimistic of a …… outcome to the discussions between the two football clubs.

WRITING TOPIC SENTENCES

1. **Read a) and b) and write appropriate topic sentences. You should avoid more than three points in a controlling idea:**

a) ……..

……..

……..

……..

Lectures usually consist of a presentation by a lecturer to a large audience of 200–300 students, who listen and take notes. This format is an efficient way to deliver information to large numbers of students at once. In contrast, seminars are smaller classes of about 10–15 students, often requiring a student presentation followed by an informal discussion. These discussions allow both students and tutors to exchange ideas and offer critical analysis. Tutorials are similar to seminars but are even smaller in size. They are designed to intellectually challenge students by encouraging them to think creatively, defend their own views, and engage critically with the arguments of others.

b) ……..……

…….

Many academics in UK universities regard seminars as even more important than lectures. One key reason is that their smaller size allows tutors to provide more focused, individualized support. In addition, the interactive nature of seminars encourages students to express and defend their opinions more freely. Because students often have some control over the topics discussed, seminars can also be adapted to suit their academic interests. When well-organized and supported by enthusiastic participation, seminars become a powerful tool for promoting intellectual growth.

2. Follow the same procedure for the paragraphs below:

a) …….…….

……..

For example, a process essay outlines a sequence of steps to achieve a specific goal, such as making a cup of tea. Another purpose is classification, which involves grouping people or objects based on shared characteristics, such as different types of insects or vehicles. A further function is comparison and contrast, where similarities and differences between two or more items - such as employment positions or films - are explored. Academic writing can also tanalyze causes and effects, explaining the reasons behind events and their consequences. Finally, one of the most essential purposes is to evaluate contrasting viewpoints, encouraging critical thinking and argument analysis.

b) …….……...……

…….…….……...……..…….

University students often engage in teamwork through group projects, classroom interaction, or extracurricular activities. This collaborative environment enables the sharing of knowledge and promotes a shared sense of purpose, which can lead to better problem-solving skills. Moreover, students learn to value each other's strengths, as well as their emotional and psychological differences. Drawing on each other's passions and intellect, students not only develop academically but may also uncover new talents. This kind of cooperation produces synergistic creativity and innovation beyond what individuals might achieve alone. Ultimately, teamwork at university prepares students for the collaborative demands of the workplace, where interdisciplinary cooperation is often key to success.

PARAGRAPH UNITY (all sentences are relevant to the topic)

1. One characteristic of good writing is unity. When a paragraph has unity, all of the sentences relate to the topic. If a topic sentence states that a paragraph will be about how to prepare for a successful job interview, *all sentences in the paragraph should refer to job interview preparation*.

2. Read each topic sentence. Draw a line through the sentence that does not support it and explain your choice.

a) **1.** An important role of library staff is to offer undergraduates both suitable resources and training. **2.** Firstly, librarians usually work together with lecturers to ensure that the library collection closely matches the needs of undergraduate students. **3.** The lecturers act as faculty liaisons and provide information on future academic directions, program needs and changes in course offerings. **4.** In addition to choosing material, library staff are usually available to assist in finding information. **5.** This may mean highlighting useful resources for a student's subject area or recommending the most appropriate online databases. **6.** Librarians may also share their knowledge of learning skills by offering short training courses, such as workshops on evaluating resources.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

.....

b) **1.** The modern term *robot* derives from the Czech word *robota* (meaning forced labour or slavery), used in Karel Čapek's play, *Rossum's Universal Robots* in 1920. **2.** They were not robots in the conventionally understood sense, as they could be mistaken for real people. **3.** The play's robots were manufactured humans which were heartlessly exploited by factory owners until they revolted and ultimately destroyed humanity. **4.** Isaac Asimov, intrigued by robots' potential for destruction, created an ethical system (his Three laws of Robotics) designed to prevent a revolt against human creators. **5.** Whether Čapek's robots were biological, like the monster in Mary Shelley's Frankenstein (1818), or mechanical was indeed not specified, but they inspired generations of writers to imagine and predict the development of electrical humanoids.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

.....

c) **1.** Yukon, which is located in the northernmost part of Canadas, is a region known for its extremities of climate. **2.** Unlike most of Canada where the most extreme heat waves occur in July, August, and even September, the Yukon's extreme heat tends to occur in June and even May. **3.** The Yukon has recorded 36 °C three times. The first time was in June 1969 when Mayo recorded a temperature of 36.1 °C (Askwith, 2020). **4.** Summers in Yukon are short, but their days are long, especially in the northern part of the territory lying above the Arctic Circle. **5.** Precipitation is generally very light, averaging only about 10 inches (250 mm) annually at Whitehorse.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

.....

d) **1.** People with strong musical intelligence have an ability to produce and appreciate music **2.** This strength may relate not only to musical sounds but to sounds in the environment as well. **3.** Learners who excel in this area may enjoy using musical instruments, audio tapes, and CDs and may like to study with music playing in the background. **4.**The development of musical intelligence may even be linked to an individual's capacity for empathy. **5.** Children especially may learn well with songs, patterns, rhythms, and any other kind of musical expression. **6.** Thus, teachers might wish to include some kinds of musical or rhythmic activities in their classrooms for students who have strength in this intelligence.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

.....

e) **1.** Happiness activities can counteract negative thoughts and bolster positive thinking. **2.** Dwelling on regrets or anxieties often has the effect of intensifying pessimistic thoughts, while hopeful expectations produced by an optimism strategy may replace such negativity. **3.** The latter may then lead to improvements in cognitive performance and physical well-being **4.** As mentioned previously, a recent study (Lyubomirsky *et al.*, 2008) has shown that individuals who actively and regularly practiced expressing gratitude or optimism began tended to find everyday events (such as meeting a friend, commuting to work or cooking dinner) more satisfying. **5.** These individuals also reported more grateful, optimistic, autonomous, and relationship-enhancing thoughts (Lyubomirsky et al., 2008).

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

f) **1.** The Earth's rainforest is being destroyed at an alarming rate, severely impacting the environment and wildlife. **2.** Rainforest once covered 14 per cent of the world's land surface, but this figure has now fallen to just 6 per cent (World Wildlife Fund, 2018). **3.** According to Travis (2018) one and a half acres of rainforest are cut down by loggers each second **4.** This appears to be causing the loss of 137 plant, animal and insect species each day, equating to 50,000 per year (Frontier, 2014). **5.** The entire remaining rainforest could disappear within a few years, having catastrophic consequences for the planet as a whole. **6.** Any solution must be based on the principle of sustainable use and development of rainforests.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

g) **1.** Michael Faraday's early life was shaped not only by material hardship but also by the emotional support of his family and religious faith**.** **2.** His father, a blacksmith who had migrated from northern England in 1791 in search of employment, was frequently ill and unable to work consistently, leaving the family in persistent poverty. **3.** Faraday's mother, a woman of quiet strength and wisdom, provided emotional support during his challenging childhood. **4.** As one of four children, Faraday often faced severe deprivation - he later recalled receiving a single loaf of bread to last an entire week. **5.** Despite these conditions, Faraday would later become known for his pioneering work in electromagnetism and

electrochemistry. **6.** The family were members of a small Christian sect known as the Sandemanians, whose spiritual teachings profoundly influenced Faraday throughout his life**. 7.** This religious affiliation not only offered emotional sustenance during his early years but also played a critical role in shaping his moral framework and approach to scientific inquiry.

Sentence number: .....

Explanation: .....

*TYPES OF SUPPORT

Supporting sentences in a paragraph should serve some purpose. They may offer a **reason**, **result, definition, comparison, example, argument, evidence, fact, quotation, etc.** Read the paragraph below and decide if each sentence gives a:

a) **reason**
b) **evidence**
c) **factual information**
d) **example**
e) **definition**
f) **argument**

The adoption of the semester system in the UK reflects a significant shift in academic scheduling aimed at improving international compatibility and student outcomes.**1.** …….. A semester refers to a teaching period that spans half the academic year; **2.** …….. for instance, Semester 1 usually begins in September and ends in January. **3.** …….. Following this schedule, students typically complete two modules per semester, with examinations held at the end of each semester. **4.** …….. One of the main motivations for the shift was to align the British academic calendar with that of other countries, thereby facilitating student mobility. **5.** …….. This rationale appears to be supported by research (Hopper, 2015; Jones, 2016) which indicates that institutions adopting the semester system experienced a 20% increase in exchange student enrolment. **6.** …….. Advocates of this system also claim that it offers pedagogical benefits by promoting a more balanced workload and enabling students to engage more deeply with a smaller number of subjects at any given time.

COHESION AND COHERENCE: BRIEF INTRODUCTION

If a text is coherent, it is understandable to the reader through the organization of its content. For example, an argument essay is coherent because it has a structure that gives unity and follows an accepted form. It begins with a statement of belief, gives the opposing arguments, refutes these, and summarizes in a final paragraph. Coherence also means the text is consistent and moves logically from one point to the next.

Coherence itself is the product of two main factors - paragraph unity and sentence cohesion. Cohesion refers to the use of lexical/grammatical devices to join sentences together, including conjunctions, reference words, substitution, ellipsis and lexical devices such as repetition of words, synonyms and collocations.

1. Can you complete the empty boxes (shaded green) in the table below?

COHESIVE DEVICES (LINKING WORDS)

LOGICAL RELATIONSHIP	**TRANSITION WORDS** Conjuncts and adverbs (sentence connectors)	**SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS** (clause connectors)	**PREPOSITIONS /PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES**
Addition			in addition to
	Mars has volcanoes, valleys, deserts, and polar ice caps. Additionally, Mars rotates similarly to Earth and has a tilt that produces seasons.		
Cause and effect	(effects)	since, as, because, so that	(causes) because of on account of due to as a consequence of as a result of owing to by reason of
	The recent supply of new homes in London has been only 27,000 a year. As a consequence, house prices have soared, and wages have failed to keep pace.		

Time or Sequence	first second third firstly secondly thirdly then next finally afterwards previously initially later subsequently	when whenever while until before after as soon as just as	up to prior to in advance of subsequent to following
	The logs and branches are fed mechanically into a chipper or grinder. Subsequently, the wood is heated in the absence of oxygen to produce charcoal.		
Rephrasing or clarification	that is (to say) namely in other words i.e. put more simply specifically in particular		
LOGICAL RELATIONSHIP	**TRANSITION WORDS** Conjuncts and adverbs (Sentence connectors)	**SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS** (clause connectors)	**PREPOSITIONS /PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES**
	The major purpose of the programme is to help students develop empathy; that is, the ability to understand the position of another person.		
Contrast		although even though while whereas	in spite of in contrast to contrary to despite different from
	Life on Earth takes many forms; nevertheless, every living organism is a variation on the common theme of DNA, RNA, and protein.		
Similarity	likewise similarly in the same way in the same manner in a similar way/manner		similar to akin to

	These winds form the Amazon rainforest by bringing moisture-laden air from the Atlantic Ocean. Similarly, the Congo rainforest forms where air from the Indian Ocean brings moisture.		
Giving examples	for example for instance to illustrate by way of illustration to take one example		such as as exemplified by a case in point
	The UK's industrial R&D is highly competitive. To take one example, the UK has just 3% of the global drug market but spends 10% of the global R&D in this sector.		

Coordinating conjunctions

and, but, so, yet, for, nor, or

2. Fill in the gaps with suitable linking expressions from the box below:

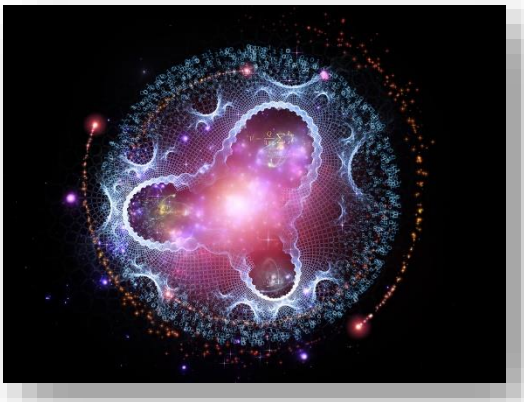
One difference among the world's seas and oceans is that the salinity varies in different climate zones. **(1)** …….., the Baltic Sea in northern Europe is only one-fourth as salty as the Red Sea in the Middle East. **(2)** …….. **(3)** …….. , water evaporates more rapidly in warm climates, **(4)** …….. the concentration of salt is greater. **(5)**…….., the surrounding land is dry; **(6)** …….., it does not contribute much freshwater to dilute the salty seawater. In cold climate zones, **(7)** …….., water evaporates relatively slowly. **(8)** …….., the runoff created by melting snow adds a considerable amount of freshwater to dilute the saline seawater.

a) Furthermore	**b)** secondly	**c)** there are two reasons for this	**d)** first of all
e) on the other hand	**f)** so that	**g)** for example	**h)** consequently

Adapted from https://dspace.aab-edu.net/bitstream/handle/123456789/699/762cdd95-bd35-4098-8064-73a43243d9ca.pdf?sequence=12&isAllowed=y

PRACTICE PROOFREADING

Extract from Seven Brief Lessons on Physics (Carlo Rovelli)



1. **Read the following text and the comments, and then make corrections (you may wish to use track changes):**

In the second and third decade of the twentieth century it was the Dane, Niels Bohr, who pioneers the growth of quantum theory. It was Bohr who understands that energy of electrons in atoms can only take over certain values, such as the energy of light, and crucial, that electrons can only 'jump' between one atom orbit and other with fixed energies, emitting or absorb a photon when they jump. These the famous 'quantum leaps'. In his institute in Copenhagen, the most fantastic young minds of the century gathered with each other to investigate and try to bring order to these bafling aspects of behaviour in the atomic world, and to get from it a coherent theory. In 1925 the equations of quantum theory final appeared, replacing the entire mechanic of newton.

Adapted from: Rovelli, C. (2016) *Seven Brief Lessons on Physics.* Penguin Books: London

2. (Optional) copy and paste your second draft to Marking Mate, and make further amendments if needed:

   http://www.readingandwritingtools.com/mm/markingmate.html

WRITING A TOPIC SENTENCE AND SUPPORTING SENTENCES

1. A **paragraph** generally contains 2-3 supporting ideas.

- These must all be relevant to the topic.
- A supporting idea can comprise any of the following: *example, evidence, fact, cause/effect, definition, recommendation, statistic, etc.,* to help make the point clear and show how it relates to the topic.

2. Take notes of supporting ideas for a paragraph related to one the topics below.

IMPORTANT: Please remember that these are neither essay titles nor topic sentences - they are simply topics (which will require more information to create a topic sentence):

a) Learning English in a globalized world
b) Introverts and/or extraverts
c) An important figure in Chinese society/culture
d) The Confucian concept of *ren*
e) Environmental impacts of Supply Chains
f) 5G technology in modern communication systems

Notes (you may wish to brainstorm ideas with other students):

a) *Supporting Idea 1*

b) *Supporting Idea 2*

c) *Supporting Idea 3 (optional), etc.*

WRITE YOUR OWN PARAGRAPH

1. Now you are going to write your own paragraph. Be careful to craft a topic sentence that gives the topic + a controlling idea that is neither too general nor too specific.

2. You should write at least 135 words and include a word count at the end of the paragraph.

3. Please fulfill the following format requirements:

- **a)** 1.5 line spacing
- **b)** A space after each full stop and comma
- **c)** Times New Roman 11-12 points
- **d)** Page numbers

BEGIN HERE

Topic sentence:

Rest of paragraph:

3. STUDENT 1: When you have finished your 1st draft of the paragraph, give it to your partner, STUDENT 2.

STUDENT 2: PEER EVALUATION OF PARAGRAPH

Name (in English) of evaluator:

……...……..…….

1. STUDENT 2: Complete a peer evaluation based on the recommendations on the PowerPoint slides I will show you; give your name as the evaluator of your partner's paragraphs.

2. To review how to create comments, click here

3. When you have completed the evaluation, please return the draft to Student 1

STUDENT 1: FINAL DRAFT OF PARAGRAPH

1. Review the evaluation made by Student 2.

2. Further review the paragraph in Marking Mate:

   (http://www.readingandwritingtools.com/mm/markingmate.html

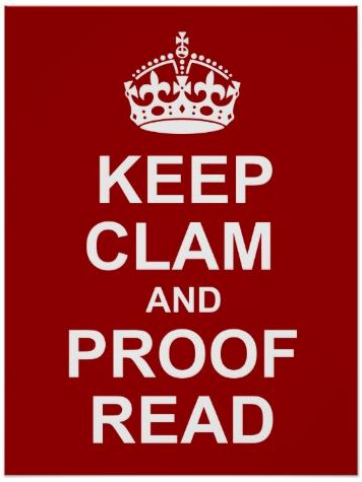
3. Based on the evaluation of your partner and recommendations made by Marking Mate, you should now write a final draft below:

FINAL DRAFT

Topic sentence:

Rest of the paragraph:

HOMEWORK: PROOFREAD AN INTRODUCTION



1. Analyze the errors of grammar, lexis or style in the introduction below; Indicate the type of error that been made and make appropriate amendments. More than one solution may be possible:

ESSAY INTRODUCTION

Having been victim of aggression **a)** between (error type: …….; correction: …….) the Second World War, China came to understand the significance of globalization and **b)** abandon (error type: ……..…….; correction: ……..…….….) the policy of **c)** isolating (error type: …….…….; correction: ……..……..). China subsequently devoted itself to **d)** establish (error type: …….; correction: ……..…….) closer relations with countries in order to ride the wave of globalization. This has significantly increased economic growth and **e)** risen (error type: …….; correction: …….) **f)** life (error type: …….; correction: …….) standards for Chinese citizens. However, the fruits of economic development have not **g)** (error type: …….; correction:…….…….) evenly distributed. According to Holden (2022) the poorest 25 per cent of Chinese households **h)** are owning (error type: …….…; correction: …….…….) just 1 per cent of the country's total wealth, and the gap in income inequality is currently widening. The purpose of this essay is to evaluate the **i)** phenomena (error type: …….; correction: …….…….) of income inequality in China, as measured by two indicators: the Gini coefficient and comparisons of income distribution in urban and **j)** natural (error type: …….; correction: …….…….) areas.

SUPPLEMENTARY: A BOOK REVIEW

WITH THE EXCEPTION OF

IN ADDITION TO

IN SPITE OF

IN PARTICULAR

ON THE WHOLE

IN CONJUNCTION WITH

IN COMPARISON WITH

IN ANY RESPECT

IN LINE WITH

IN TERMS OF

Use the phrases above to complete the paragraph below:

The *Guide to the Semi-Colon in English* was written by Keith Pedant **(1)** …… a team of researchers at Boredham University. **(2)**…… previous works on the semi-colon, this is a very substantial volume. **(3)** …… the main text there are a number of appendices. These are to some extent the most useful parts of the book as, **(4)** …..……..……. modern linguistic practice, they provide a wealth of real data. **(5)** …….. its potentially dry topic, the book contains many fascinating examples, in the sections dealing with the history of the semi-colon **(6)** …….. **(7)** …….. the final chapter, this book may be of some interest to the general reader as well as the specialist, but **(8)** …… is mainly for those who have a professional interest in punctuation marks. If it fails **(9)**……, it is in relation to recent changes in the punctuation of e-communication, **(10)**…… the conventions of text-messaging, tweets and similar media.

RECORDING NEW VOCABULARY

You may use this page to record important new vocabulary:

WORD	PRONUNCIATION	WORD FORM	
Example sentence(s)			
Example sentence(s)			
Example sentence(s)			
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